

JDScience 11+ English Practice Paper 1 — Answers and Explanations

English · Answers and Explanations

Name _____

Date _____

Score _____

Recommended time: —

Questions: 40

Calculator: Not required unless a question says otherwise

Instructions

1. Issue separately from the pupil paper.
2. Accept clearly equivalent wording for short answers where noted.

This is an original JDScience practice paper written for school entrance exam preparation. It is not an official GL Assessment, CEM, CSSE, school or publisher paper.

Mark scheme

1. B — The opening sentence says Mira 'stepped onto the quay' where fishing boats rocked in the harbour.

2. 40 years / forty years — The passage states he had been the lighthouse keeper for forty years.

3. C — Mira 'did not trust him' and had seen him leave with something heavy wrapped in cloth, showing suspicion.

4. Speaking as if every sentence were a secret / treating sentences like secrets — He has 'a habit of speaking as if every sentence were a secret.'

5. C — Without the reflector, ships approaching the reef would have only the stars, 'and stars were not enough in fog.'

6. The (main) reflector — She finds that 'the main reflector was missing — the polished metal disc that threw the beam far across the water.'

7. B — The sea is given the human action of breathing and sighing, which is personification.

8. C — His face first shows shock, then 'hardened into something colder,' and he claims it is council business.

9. The reflector / the (missing) reflector — She seizes the reflector from the bag and backs toward the stairs.

Mark scheme

10. C — The narrator states clearly: 'Today she intended to find out what he had taken.'

11. steep and slippery with dew / steep and slippery — The path is described as 'steep and slippery with dew.'

12. B — He has the stolen reflector and wants to sell it before anyone realises, so one more night of darkness would help him escape notice.

13. B — Two fishermen and Mrs Hale from the post office climb the path to help.

14. To remember who the light is for — He whispers, 'A keeper's first duty is to remember who the light is for.'

15. B — The story begins in damp mist with a failed light and ends with the beam restored and the mist lifted.

16. B — She discovers the work is 'quieter than she had imagined, full of small careful tasks rather than dramatic rescues.'

17. C — The council asks her to help train the new keeper, but she does not yet know whether she will become the official keeper.

18. It does not forgive carelessness, but rewards those who watch / keep your eyes open — He says the sea 'does not forgive carelessness, but it rewards those who watch,' and tells her to keep her eyes open.

Mark scheme

19. B — 'Like a damp grey curtain' is a simile, and the description creates strong visual/tactile imagery.

20. B — The verb 'whispering' suggests soft, stealthy movement as she enters secretly.

21. She needs to stop him taking/selling the reflector immediately so the light can work and ships stay safe — He is about to remove the reflector for good; waiting would leave ships at risk and allow evidence to disappear.

22. B — 'The Stolen Beam' reflects the central conflict: the theft of the reflector that creates the lighthouse beam.

23. C — Mira wonders if the horn sounds 'grateful'; after the light is restored, linking it to safe passage at sea.

24. She felt fierce pride when the lamp flared / the same fierce pride she felt when she ran with the reflector — The passage says she felt 'the same fierce pride she had felt on the night she ran down the tower stairs...'

25. B — Mira risks confrontation to restore the light for sailors' safety, embodying responsibility and courage.

26. B — A comma introduces the quotation, the quoted question starts with a capital, and it ends with a question mark inside the speech marks.

27. B — The correct spelling is 'announcement' (announce + ment, with the 'e' retained).

Mark scheme

28. B — 'Uneasy' here means worried or anxious.

29. C — 'Cold' describes the noun 'wind', so it is an adjective.

30. B — 'Boat's' shows possession by one boat; 'ropes' is a simple plural and needs no apostrophe.

31. C — 'Neither' is singular, so the singular verb 'was' is correct: 'Neither ... was willing...'

32. B — 'Ajar' means slightly open; the opposite is shut (or closed).

33. B — The subject pronoun 'I' is required ('Mira and I'), and the plural subject takes 'climbed'.

34. A — 'Quieter' compares two levels of quietness and is a comparative adjective.

35. A — The fronted adverbial 'After school' should be followed by a comma: 'After school, Mira returned...'

36. B — The correct spelling is 'separate' (remember 'par' in the middle).

Mark scheme

37. C — A semicolon can link two closely related independent clauses without a conjunction.

38. C — The prefix 'un-' negates the base word: unfinished = not finished.

39. C — Here 'stubborn' suggests the ticking continues steadily and persistently.

40. C — 'The reflector was restored' uses passive voice: the subject receives the action.